European Society for Mechanobiology
www.mechanobiology.eu

COMMUNITY CONSULTATION · DECEMBER 2024 TO JUNE 2025

Shaping the European Mechanobiology Community

What 216 researchers told us about how mechanobiology in Europe should come together

216
responses from researchers, institutes and companies

30
countries of work, across Europe and beyond

30%
PhD students, postdocs and early-career researchers

91
respondents offering to help build the society

Mechanobiology brings together biology, physics, engineering and medicine around one question: how living matter senses and responds to mechanical forces. In Europe this community is large and active, and it meets in many places. Following a community meeting in London, we invited researchers to tell us how a European Society for Mechanobiology could serve them best. This report presents what they said.

Key messages

A community ready to come together. Respondents currently meet through cell mechanics and mechanobiology meetings, biophysics societies and biomechanics societies. A shared home connects these circles.

A European conference comes first, followed by workshops and schools, and by consensus on methods, measurements and databases.

Building and supporting, together. 69% want the society to build the community through networking and training and to support it through funding and advocacy.

A sustainable model is within reach. 89% would join with a personal annual fee, most of them at up to €60 a year, and a third see room for institutional contributions.

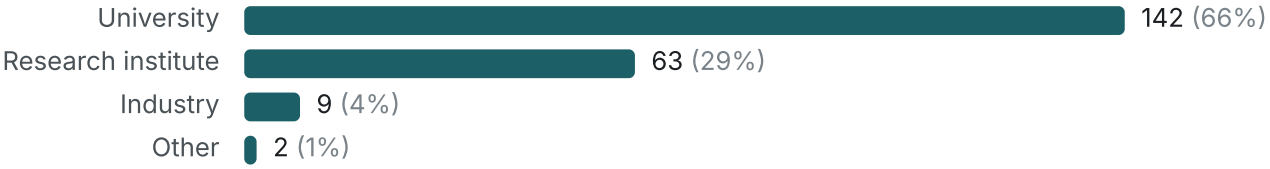
Many hands. 91 people offered their time, with events, mechanobiology stories, training and editorial initiatives drawing most interest.

1 · WHO TOOK PART

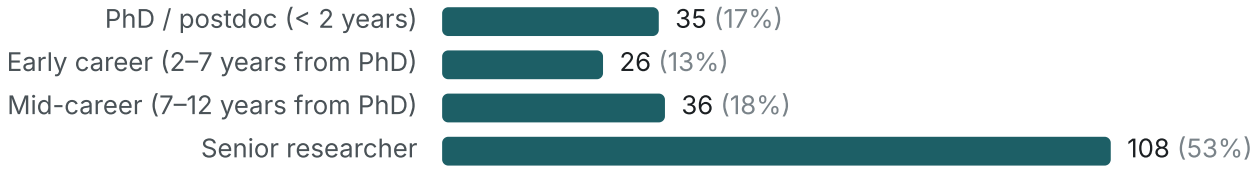
A broad, international and multi-generational community

216 people responded, most of them in December 2024 (186 responses), with the survey remaining open until June 2025. Two thirds work in universities and almost a third in research institutes, and 9 in industry. Senior researchers make up half of those who gave their career stage, and early-career researchers, from PhD students to those within seven years of their PhD, account for 30%.

Where respondents work

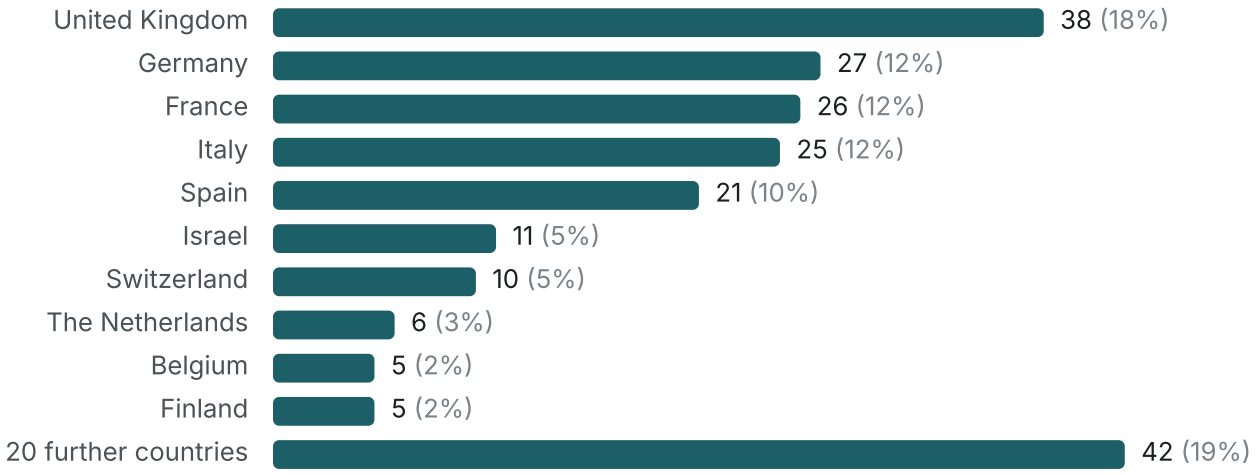


Career stage



205 respondents gave their career stage.

Country of work



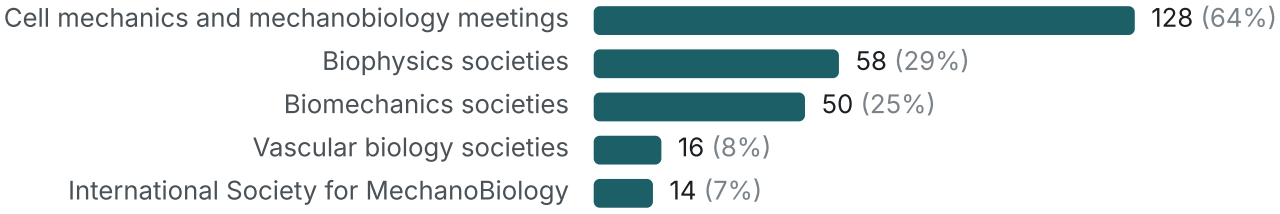
Respondents work in 30 countries. The strong UK representation reflects the survey's launch after a meeting in London.

2 · WHERE THE COMMUNITY MEETS TODAY

Many circles, ready to connect

Mechanobiologists meet in several communities at once. Most respondents engage with dedicated cell mechanics and mechanobiology meetings, and many are also active in biophysics and biomechanics societies, as well as in vascular biology, tissue engineering, cell biology and optics. This breadth is a strength of the field, and a European society gives it a common reference point.

Communities and societies respondents engage with most



200 respondents answered; several choices were possible. A further 63 mentions named other societies, from tissue engineering to optics and cell biology.

3 · WHAT THE SOCIETY SHOULD DO

A conference, schools and shared methods

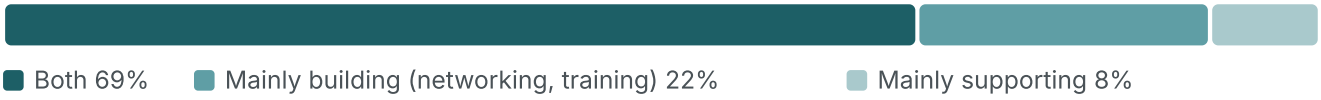
Respondents ranked ten possible activities. A European conference came first by a clear margin, ranked top by 106 respondents (49%). Workshops and schools came second, followed by actions towards scientific and technical consensus on methods, measurements and databases, a news hub for the community, and activities that raise awareness of mechanobiology among clinicians, companies and policy makers.

Priority of activities (average ranking)



Score = 11 minus the average rank, so 10 means ranked first by everyone and 1 means ranked last by everyone. All 216 respondents ranked all ten activities.

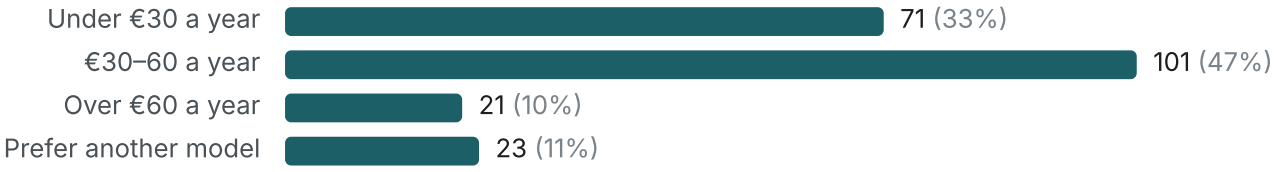
Building the community, supporting it, or both?



Personal membership as the foundation

Personal annual fees are the most common model for learned societies, and 89% of respondents would subscribe. Most would commit up to €60 a year. Discounts for conferences and events are the most valued benefit, followed by prizes and mobility grants, and many respondents would support the society with no direct reward at all.

Personal annual fee respondents would commit



What would motivate a personal fee

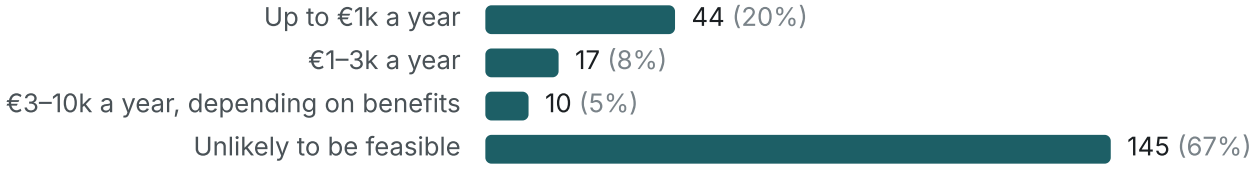


192 respondents; several choices possible.

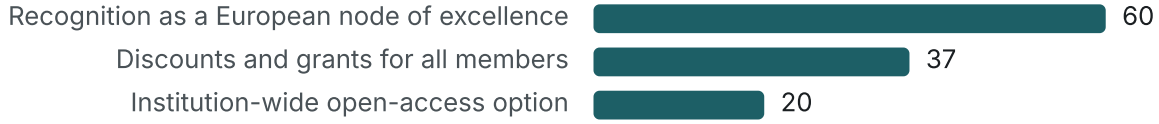
Institutions as partners

A third of respondents see room for an annual contribution from their institution, mostly below €1k a year and in some cases up to €10k. The strongest motivation is recognition as a European node of excellence in mechanobiology. Several respondents also suggested linking membership to conference registration, so that joining the society becomes part of attending its meetings.

Could your institution contribute?



What would motivate an institution



69 respondents; several choices possible.

What respondents asked of the society

Respondents shared almost a hundred comments and suggestions. Six themes recur.

> **A broad and welcoming home.**
> Mechanobiology is an interdisciplinary mosaic of biologists, physicists, engineers, materials scientists and clinicians. Respondents want a society that brings these backgrounds together, welcomes newcomers, and gives researchers from engineering and physical sciences a full voice.

> **Connecting existing communities.**
> Respondents encouraged close partnership with established conferences and societies in cell mechanics, biophysics, biomechanics, biomaterials and tissue engineering, with joint sessions and events that strengthen each other.

> **A bridge to the clinic and to industry.**
> Many asked the society to raise awareness of mechanobiology among clinicians and companies, to involve medical doctors and industrial partners, and to help translate research into clinical applications.

> **Early-career researchers at the centre.**
> Suggestions include a young investigator section with a voice in decisions, summer and winter schools, short research visits between laboratories, and a place to find positions and mentorship.

> **Shared tools, methods and knowledge.**
> Respondents asked for shared protocols, educational resources and instruction for those starting out, and for common standards across the field, with particular value for groups with fewer resources.

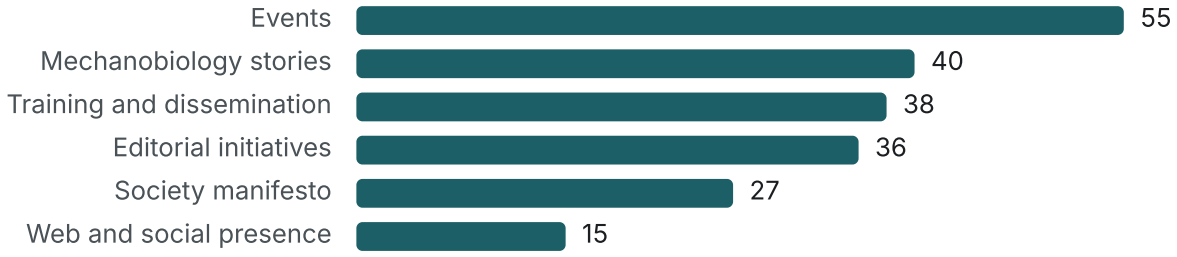
> **An inclusive and open culture.**
> Respondents asked for a society open to all laboratories, small and large, with events that are accessible to researchers with caring responsibilities and that reach out to the wider public and young people.

6 · GETTING INVOLVED

91 offers of help

Of the 202 respondents who answered, 91 (45%) offered to help in the coming months, and many signed up for task forces exploring the first areas of action.

Interest in task forces



Number of respondents interested in each task force; several choices possible.

These results now guide the founding steps of the society. To follow its progress or to get involved, visit **www.mechanobiology.eu**.

About this consultation. An online questionnaire was open from 9 December 2024 to 3 June 2025 and was shared through mechanobiology networks across Europe. Responses were anonymous; contact details given by volunteers are not reported. Percentages are calculated on the respondents who answered each question and are rounded to the nearest whole number.